

Key Points in Support of Keeping Our Neighborhood at Lemon Road ES

1. Strong Community Connections

- Our families are deeply woven into the Lemon Road community - from PTA and classroom volunteers to student leaders **and after-school programs.**
- Lemon Road fosters meaningful relationships across neighborhoods, and our children's friendships and cohorts are firmly established here.
- Every student community within Lemon Road deserves equal consideration and stability; removing our neighborhood would disrupt a quarter of the school's student body.

2. Maintaining Stability and Avoiding Unnecessary Disruptions

- The **current** FCPS Scenario 4 plan presents no changes to Lemon Road's existing boundaries, a solution that the broader community supports.
- Introducing a last-minute rezoning would upend a year-long process, causing avoidable instability for students, families, and staff.
- Moving our neighborhood would reduce Lemon Road's enrollment below 80%, risking cuts to programs, staffing, and resources.
- Families would face logistical challenges with Freedom Hill's later start time (9:20 a.m. vs. 8:15 a.m.) and limited availability of before- and after-care programs.

3. Cohort Continuity and Academic Consistency

- Students from our neighborhood progress through the same AAP and secondary school pathways as their peers, preserving academic and social continuity.
- Rezoning would create fragmented student pathways and unnecessary transfers, particularly for AAP-eligible students who would need to travel significantly farther (Westbriar is 2.5× farther than Lemon Road).

4. Capacity and Planning Data Do Not Support Boundary Changes

- FCPS projections show overall declining enrollment through 2030 due to lower birth rates and housing trends.
- Scenario 4 already relieves Kilmer's overcrowding by resolving other split-feeder issues; there's no justification for an extra and unnecessary elementary move.
- Freedom Hill's capacity is not identified as a current FCPS priority for adjustment.

5. Safety and Transportation

- No elementary students in our neighborhoods cross Route 7 on foot; all are bused or driven.
- Rerouting buses would add costs and logistical burdens amid existing driver shortages.
- Major roads border all nearby schools (Route 7, Great Falls, Gallows, Chain Bridge, etc.); singling out one neighborhood as a safety concern is inconsistent.

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6. Socioeconomic and Policy Considerations

- Our neighborhood contributes to the socioeconomic diversity that enriches Lemon Road's learning environment.
- Removing townhomes and apartments while retaining predominantly higher-priced single-family homes would make both Lemon Road and Freedom Hill less balanced, contrary to FCPS' equity goals.
- Lemon Road's mission, centered on the "Other People Matter Mindset," thrives on its diversity and inclusivity.

7. Process Integrity

- The Pimmit Hills proposal represents only a small subset of that community and was introduced late in the review process without collaboration or transparency.
- We value our long-standing friendships with all families in the Lemon Road community and are disappointed that such disruptive recommendations were advanced without discussion.
- We urge FCPS and the School Board to maintain stability, equity, and community continuity by keeping our neighborhood at Lemon Road ES.